

In May 1962, concerned about the possibility of losing Cuba either to another US-backed invasion or to a Maoist coup in Havana, Khrushchev decided to install Soviet missiles on the island. He is shown here in the company of his key foreign policy advisers. Seated next to the Soviet leader is his minister of defense, Marshal Rodion Malinovsky, who supported Khrushchev's Cuban adventure. First Deputy Prime Minister Anastas Mikoyan, who opposed it, is third from left. (KEYSTONE PRESS / ALAMY STOCK PHOTO)